

RISK vs. REWARD

Series Overview

RISK vs. REWARD is a high-stakes studio game show that transforms trivia into a psychological test of confidence under pressure.

Each episode features a single contestant—or a pair playing as a team—competing for a potential \$1,000,000 prize. But unlike traditional quiz formats, knowledge alone is not enough.

Before locking in each answer, contestants must decide how much they trust their choice. That decision is made in real time through a dynamic risk slider that determines both their potential winnings and their long-term path through the game.

Every question becomes a moment of visible internal conflict:

“Do I trust what I think I know?”

TONE & PRESENTATION

The show is designed as a high-production studio event in the tradition of *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire*, but with a more psychologically transparent and modern decision-based engine.

The visual and production style emphasizes:

- dramatic lighting and focused contestant isolation
- close-up reaction shots during decision-making
- tense, cinematic music underscoring each lock-in moment
- real-time graphical displays showing changing dollar outcomes
- a dynamic interface where viewers see risk and reward shift as the slider moves

The camera lingers on hesitation:

- the pause before committing
- the movement of the slider
- the visible uncertainty in the contestant’s decision

HOST ROLE

The host plays a critical tonal balance between tension and relief.

They:

- guide contestants through escalating stakes
- explain consequences in simple, emotional language
- and help translate complex risk outcomes into clear human stakes

The host also serves as a pressure valve—adding humor, personality, and commentary that helps break tension without undermining it.

GAME EXPERIENCE

Each episode is a contained psychological journey built around 12 questions of increasing consequence.

Contestants:

- choose categories for each question
- answer multiple-choice trivia
- set confidence via a real-time slider
- immediately see the financial impact of their decision
- and watch how much they can still win evolve after every round

The key tension is not just whether answers are correct—but how much the contestant was willing to risk on their belief.

EMOTIONAL ENGINE

RISK vs. REWARD is built around a simple but powerful idea:

People often reveal more through their confidence than through their knowledge.

This creates a natural progression of emotional states:

- early optimism and experimentation
- mid-game recalibration and doubt
- late-game pressure and regret or validation

Because every decision has lasting consequences, the game builds toward a uniquely personal outcome for each contestant.

No two games feel the same—even with identical questions.

Knowledge gets you in the game.

Confidence determines the outcome.

AUDIENCE EXPERIENCE

For viewers, the show is designed to be highly participatory.

At every question, the audience naturally asks:

“What would I do?”

Followed immediately by:

“How much would I risk on being right?”

This creates constant engagement, as viewers compare:

- their confidence level
- their willingness to risk money
- and their interpretation of the question difficulty

The result is a show that is both:

- competitively engaging
- and psychologically reflective

WHY IT WORKS AS A SERIES

RISK vs. REWARD sustains across episodes because:

- every game follows a different path based on how contestants manage confidence
- contestant personality strongly affects outcomes
- and the confidence mechanic creates endless variation in strategy

The format naturally generates:

- dramatic highs and lows
- visible regret and validation moments
- and unpredictable final outcomes, even with similar knowledge levels

POSITIONING

RISK vs. REWARD sits in the modern evolution of studio game formats:

- visually simple to follow
- emotionally complex to play
- and immediately understandable to audiences

It combines the clarity of classic quiz shows with the psychological tension of modern decision-based formats.

TAGLINE

Knowing the answer is only half the game.

Knowing how much to trust it wins the money.

CREATED BY

Eddie Lawhorn
(256) 975-2238

email: eddielawhorn@bellsouth.net
website: <https://eddielawhorn.com>